

Elf

Standing noticeably taller than average human beings, the Elves of Pliiara possess a graceful and slender physique that is strikingly accentuated by long, tapered ears. Their eyes are wide and almond shaped, filled with large and vibrantly colored pupils that immediately draw the attention of outsiders. It is a frequent mistake among other species to assume that their thin limbs indicate weakness or feebleness, as an elf can wield surprising physical power when pushed to action.

Among all the known inhabitants of Pliiara, the Elves remain among the longest living creatures on the map. This vast longevity shapes every single aspect of their culture, philosophy, and everyday existence. Because an individual elf can expect to remain active within the same locale for many centuries, short term solutions simply do not work for them. By sheer necessity, they must learn to build and maintain deeply sustainable lifestyles. These enduring habits are most easily achieved when they choose to work in harmony with the natural world, rather than attempting to force nature to bend to their collective will.

Their deep rooted connection to the wilderness is not driven purely by practical needs or simple survival strategies. Elves naturally find themselves far more in tune with raw nature and spiritual energies than short lived species ever could be. Their long lifespans give them ample time to cultivate deep connections to mystical abilities, allowing them to sense subtle shifts in the land that others completely miss. As a generally patient and docile people, they spend their vast lifespans seeking a genuine, profound understanding of their world and the invisible forces that drive it.

Perhaps the most fascinating aspect of these people is the way their physical forms respond to their surroundings. The body of an elf slowly changes over time, gradually taking on a physical representation of their mental, emotional, and spiritual states. Furthermore, those who dwell within a specific region for an extended period find themselves physically adapting to match the local terrain. This shift is most noticeable in their coloration, which subtly alters to mirror the surrounding landscape.

Because of this unique biological trait, the overall coloration across the entire elf population varies wildly, proving far more diverse than human populations ever display. Yet within any single community, the local inhabitants often look remarkably similar to one another because they draw from the exact same environment. Forest dwelling communities, for instance, frequently exhibit rich variations of green, deep brown, and warm tan across their hair, eyes, and skin tones. Through this seamless blend of physical adaptation, deep spiritual awareness, and timeless patience, the Elves remain intimately tied to the living heartbeat of Pliiara.

Racial Traits

Ability Scores. Your Dexterity Score increases by 2

Age. Although elves reach physical maturity around the same age as humans, the elven understanding of adulthood reaches far beyond mere biological growth. To an elf, true maturity encompasses extensive worldly experience and spiritual growth. An elf typically claims adulthood and chooses an adult name around 100 years of age, and individuals can live to be 750 years old.

Alignment. Elves value freedom, variety, and personal self expression, which leads them to lean strongly toward the gentler aspects of chaos. They cherish and protect the freedom of others just as fiercely as their own. Driven by compassion and respect for life, they are far more often good than not.

Size. Elves range from under 5 feet to over 6 feet tall, maintaining remarkably slender builds throughout their lives. Your size is Medium.

Speed. Your base walking speed is 30 feet.

Darkvision. Accustomed to twilight forests and the night sky, you have superior vision in dark and dim conditions. You can see in dim light within 60 feet of you as if it were bright light, and in darkness as if it were dim light. You cannot discern color in darkness, only shades of gray.

Keen Senses. You have natural proficiency in the Perception skill.

Fey Ancestry. Your heritage grants you resistance to certain magical effects. You have advantage on saving throws against being charmed, and magic cannot put you to sleep.

Trance. Elves do not need to sleep in the way humans do. Instead, they meditate deeply for 4 hours a day, remaining fully semiconscious during this period. The Common word for this mental state is a trance. While meditating, you experience a unique form of dreaming; these dreams are actually structured mental exercises that have become reflexive through long years of practice. After resting in this manner, you gain the exact same benefits that a human receives from 8 hours of deep sleep.

Languages. You can speak, read, and write Common and Elvish. Elvish is a remarkably fluid language, renowned for its subtle intonations, delicate cadence, and intricate grammatical structures. Elven literature is vast, rich, and deeply varied, spanning centuries of recorded history, philosophy, and myth. Beyond their written works, their songs and poems are famous across all lands, celebrated for their haunting beauty and emotional depth. Bards of many different ancestral backgrounds routinely dedicate years to learning the language simply to add authentic Elvish ballads and poetic epics to their performing repertoires.

Elf Sub-Races

Frost Elf

High in the frozen reaches of the world, where icy winds scour the bare rock and severe winter deters most civilized life, the Frost Elves thrive. These solitary people have made their sanctuary in some of the most unforgiving climates on Pliiara, establishing their primary cities and settlements throughout the frozen expanses of Tundwine. While smaller, scattered populations occasionally brave the bleak conditions of the Barren, they almost never venture into Angoran, holding a deep seated aversion to the creatures that inhabit those lands.

Towering over most of their kin, Frost Elves stand an average of six feet tall, making them one of the tallest elven subraces. Their long, distinctive ears often droop slightly along the sides of their head unless held close or tucked beneath warm coverings. To mirror their bitter surroundings, their skin displays a striking, dark shade of grayish blue that almost perfectly matches the color of their hair.

Although centuries of living in extreme climates have made them hardy, they remain mortal creatures who still feel the bite of a severe blizzard. To survive the harshest storms, they have developed a unique mystical gift: an innate magic that allows them to generate living flame for warmth at a moment's notice. Highly reclusive and fiercely independent, Frost Elves rarely invite outsiders into their homes, viewing other races as little more than an unwelcome nuisance.

Ability Scores. Your Constitution Score increases by 1.

Cold Core. You have resistance to cold damage.

Frost Protection. Your connection to the harsh, frozen wilderness manifests as an innate ability to manifest life saving fire. You learn the Produce Flame cantrip. Starting at 10th level, you can also cast Flame Shield once per long rest without expending a spell slot. Wisdom is your spellcasting ability for these spells.

High Elf

The High Elves are the oldest elven lineage on Pliiara and the most abundant across the realm. Their presence spans almost every major region, including the dense jungles of Amobo, the grand cities of Highpeak, and the sun baked expanses of Duror. Because they are so ubiquitous, whenever a traveler or scholar refers simply to an elf without specifying a subrace, they are almost certainly speaking of a High Elf.

Standing an average of 5 feet tall and weighing just over 100 pounds, High Elves possess a light frame paired with a refined poise. Their personal style depends heavily on where they live. Those who roam the wilds lean toward vibrant garments anchored by green and gray cloaks designed to blend with forest foliage. Conversely, the vast numbers who prefer urban life, courtly politics, and settled civilization tend to wear opulent, highly tailored attire that projects a distinctly haughty aesthetic.

Owing to their extraordinary lifespans, High Elves are extraordinarily common in positions of authority. Kingdoms and governing bodies frequently seek them out to serve as head councilors and esteemed magistrates, valuing their ability to navigate complex political landscapes with centuries of experience.

Ability Scores. Your Intelligence Score increases by 1.

Elf Weapon Training. You have proficiency with the longsword, shortsword, shortbow, and longbow.

Cantrip. You know one cantrip of your choice from the wizard spell list. Intelligence is your spellcasting ability for this spell.

Extra Language. You can speak, read, and write one additional language of your choice.

Elf Sub-Races

Sun Elf

Sometimes called Gold Elves, Sun Elves are a distinct elven subrace drawn to scorching heat and arid deserts. They hold a core cosmological belief that the sun serves as the ultimate source of all magic on Pliiara. While they do not doubt Plii's existence or the divine story surrounding her, they contend that she placed the sun in the sky specifically to empower the world's magical forces. Consequently, Sun Elves feel nearest to their creator in the hottest environments. In these sun drenched lands, they devote much of their time to deep meditation, harnessing intense sunlight to rapidly regenerate their physical bodies, though doing so exacts a severe toll.

Their relentless pursuit of spiritual enlightenment and ancient knowledge directly drives their desire to draw as close to Plii's divine warmth as possible. Standing an average of 5 feet tall with a slender frame, Sun Elves rival humans in height while remaining noticeably distinct in appearance. Living up to their golden moniker, they possess rich bronze or gold skin paired with hair of matching hues. A few rare individuals display shades of bright golden blonde or vibrant red. Their striking almond eyes are almost universally vivid green or brilliant yellow, echoing the sunlit domains they inhabit.

Ability Scores. Your Constitution Score increases by 1.

Elf Weapon Training. You have proficiency with the longsword, shortsword, shortbow, and longbow.

Acclimated. You have resistance to fire damage.

Solar Recharge. Once per day while in direct sunlight, you can meditate for one hour to unlock the divine power granted by Plii. Upon completing this hour of meditation, you gain the full benefits of a long rest and cure all active diseases and poisons affecting you.

After using this feature, you cannot regain hit points from any source, including magical healing or potions, though you can still be stabilized if dying.

Additionally, you cannot use your Trance feature until you complete a standard long rest.

Wyld Elf

The Wyld Elves of Pliiara are a nomadic people who rarely settle in one place until old age. Constantly moving, they form tight bands of three to five members who travel as family units to explore the world. On rare occasions, these small groups journey alongside wandering bands of Plains Orcs. It is extremely uncommon to see a Wyld Elf out on their own or as a part of an adventuring party.

Wyld Elves share a close ancestral connection with High Elves, making infants of both subraces almost indistinguishable at birth. However, physical differences emerge as they grow. Wyld Elves reach a height of only three to four feet and develop unusually large ears, which many use as an informal gauge of their ancestral purity. Some individuals are born with sleek, glistening wings on their backs, while others manifest magical gifts to assist their travels.

While Wyld Elves avoid sprawling cities, they occasionally visit small villages and remote towns to trade for essential supplies. Their style during these visits varies greatly. Some favor dark clothing to stay unnoticed, whereas others wear vibrant colors and entertain locals with lively performances.

Ability Scores. Your Charisma Score increases by 1.

Wyld Elf Weapon Training. You have proficiency with the shortbow, longbow, net, and whip.

Wyld Elf Diversity. Your unique heritage manifests either as physical wings or as an innate connection to nature magic. Choose one of the following options:

- Fey Wings: Silvery, pale wings emerge from your back. You gain a flying speed equal to your walking speed while you are not wearing heavy armor.
- Wild Magic: You learn two cantrips of your choice from the Druid spell list. You also learn one 1st-level spell from the Druid spell list, which you can cast a number of times equal to your Intelligence modifier per long rest. When you reach 10th level, you learn one additional 1st-level spell from the Druid spell list. Intelligence is your spellcasting ability for these spells.